

ARJUN CHANDRA

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ABOUT ME	I am a PhD student in the computer science department at Stanford. My research is at the intersection of machine learning, cognitive science, and neuroscience. I am supported by an NSF Graduate Research Fellowship.	
EDUCATION	Stanford University	Stanford, CA
	<i>Ph.D. Computer Science</i> • Current: First year research rotations	2026 – Present
	Boston University	Boston, MA
	<i>B.A. Physics & Computer Science</i> • GPA: 3.98/4.00 • Advisors: Boqing Gong, Venkatesh Saligrama, Irving Bigio • Relevant Coursework: – Multimodal Machine Learning (Graduate) <i>Project: Targeted Caption Generation Improves Compositional Reasoning in VLMs</i> – Quantum Computing (Graduate) <i>Project: Lattice-Based Key Encapsulation Mechanisms in Post-Quantum Cryptography</i> – Bandit Algorithms (Graduate) <i>Project: Fair Algorithms for Multi-Agent Multi-Armed Bandits</i>	2021 – 2025
WORK EXPERIENCE	Adobe San Jose, CA	May 2024 – Aug 2024
	<i>AI/ML Intern - Machine Learning Engineer</i> • Implemented and deployed a scalable LLM-based recommendation engine on roadmap for future release in Adobe Experience Platform AI Assistant • Built and managed Intern Connect, a Slack app that pairs hundreds of Adobe interns around the world for weekly virtual coffee chats	
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	UT Austin: Developing Intelligence Lab	May 2026 – Aug 2026
	<i>Visting Researcher Advisor: Chen Yu</i> • Egocentric gaze estimation to generate pseudo-labels for vision-language model pretraining	
	Boston University: Data Science & Machine Learning	June 2025 – Aug 2026
	<i>Research Fellow Advisor: Venkatesh Saligrama</i> • Automatic evaluation methods and synthetic data to probe failure modes in speech-to-speech models	
	Boston University: Image & Video Computing	Jan 2025 – Aug 2026
	<i>Research Assistant Advisor: Boqing Gong</i> • Data-efficient pretraining of multimodal foundation models via developmentally plausible learning mechanisms	
	Adobe Research	Aug 2024 – May 2025
	<i>Student Researcher Advisor: Yunyao Li</i> • Multi-source knowledge retrieval to improve factual accuracy and interpretability in text-to-video generation	
	Boston University: Biomedical Optics Lab	Sept 2023 – Dec 2025
	<i>Research Assistant Advisor: Irving Bigio</i> • 3D object detection to identify myelin degeneration in microscopic brain imaging of late-stage Alzheimer's and CTE patients	

PUBLICATIONS	1. Patrick Lutz, Themistoklis Haris, Arjun Chandra, Aditya Gangrade, Venkatesh Saligrama. <i>Symmetry Reveals Layerwise Dynamics: How Transformers Perform In-Context Classification</i>. ICML 2026 Spotlight. 2. Shengao Wang, Wenqi Wang, Zecheng Wang, Max Whitton, Michael Wakeham, Arjun Chandra, (+14 authors), Kate Saenko, Venkatesh Saligrama, Boqing Gong. <i>BabyVLM-V2: Toward Developmentally Grounded Pretraining and Benchmarking of Vision Foundation Models</i>. CVPR 2026. 3. Arjun Chandra*, Kevin Miller*, Venkatesh Ravichandran, Constantinos Papayiannis, Venkatesh Saligrama. <i>Hearing Between the Lines: Unlocking the Reasoning Power of LLMs for Speech Evaluation</i>. EACL 2026 Findings. 4. Shengao Wang, Arjun Chandra, Aoming Liu, Venkatesh Saligrama, Boqing Gong. <i>BabyVLM: Data-Efficient Pretraining of VLMs Inspired by Infant Learning</i>. ICCV 2025. 5. Daniel Lee*, Arjun Chandra*, Yang Zhou, Yunyao Li, Simone Conia. <i>Rewind and Render: Towards Factually Accurate Text-to-Video Generation with Distilled Knowledge Retrieval</i>. AAAI 2025 Demonstration Program. 6. Anna Novoseltseva, Arjun Chandra, (+3 authors), Irving Bigio. <i>Accelerating Myelin Defect Detection in Neurodegenerative Disorders: A Human-in-the-Loop Deep Learning Approach with Birefringence Microscopy</i>. Neurophotonics. 7. Anna Novoseltseva, Gulce Kureli, Shuaibin Chang, Jiarui Yang, Precious Antinew, Arjun Chandra, (+5 authors), David Boas, Irving Bigio. <i>Imaging myelin degradation in ex vivo prefrontal cortex tissue blocks in Alzheimer’s disease and chronic traumatic encephalopathy</i>. Alzheimer’s & Dementia.
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	• Teaching Assistant, CS 460 (Database Systems) • Course Assistant, CS 460 (Database Systems) • Learning Assistant, PY212 (General Physics 2) • Learning Assistant, PY252 (Electricity & Magnetism) • Peer Tutor, Educational Resource Center Spring 2025 Fall 2024 Fall 2023 Spring 2023 2022 – 2024
AWARDS & HONORS	• Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation • Katzin Prize, UC San Diego • Faculty Award for Interdisciplinary Majors, Boston University • UROP Student Research Award, Boston University • SAEF Award, Boston University • Third Place, MIT iQuHack 2026 2026 2025 2025 2024 2024
LEADERSHIP & OUTREACH	• Student Mentor, Boston University RISE • Playspace Volunteer, Horizons for Homeless Children • Peer Mentor, Boston University PRISM • Classroom Assistant, Boston University Children’s Center 2026 2025 – 2026 2024 – 2025 2024